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Bull

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(54) *RUDBECKIA* PLANT NAMED
‘BULLRUDIHIR 116’

(50) Latin Name: *Rudbeckia hirta* L.
Varietal Denomination: BullRudihir 116

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(57) ABSTRACT

A new and distinct variety of *Rudbeckia* plant having an
upright, compact growth habit and large, semi-double, rich
yellow blooms with a dark brown center.

1 Drawing Sheet

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Botanical classification: *Rudbeckia hirta* L.
Varietal denomination: ‘BullRudihir 116’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention comprises a new and distinct cul-
tivar of *Rudbeckia* plant known by the varietal name ‘Bull-
Rudihir 116’. The new variety was discovered in August of
2019 in Gönnebek, Germany as the result of a planned
breeding program with the purposes of providing *Rudbeckia*
plants with improved growth, more uniformity, a compact
growth habit, increased branching, attractive foliage, large
flowers, unique flower colors, and double flowers. The new
variety is the result of a cross between an unpatented
Rudbeckia hirta L. variety having an internal breeder’s
reference of “BR 56-2018” (female parent) and an
unpatented *Rudbeckia hirta* L. variety having an internal
breeder’s reference of “BR 21-2017” (male parent) from the
breeder’s own collection. The new variety was first asexu-
ally reproduced via in-vitro tissue culture cuttings in Gönne-
bek, Germany in September of 2019. The new variety is
similar to its parental varieties in botanical classification, but
exhibits bigger flowers, increased branching, and more
attractive foliage than both of its parental varieties. Further,
‘BullRudihir 116’ exhibits a different colored flower center
than its female parent and a more compact growth habit with
semi-double flowers that distinguishes it from its male
parent.

When ‘BullRudihir 116’ is compared to *Rudbeckia hirta*
L. variety named ‘Goldilocks’ (unpatented), ‘BullRudihir
116’ is similar to ‘Goldilocks’ in botanical classification, but
‘BullRudihir 116’ exhibits semi-double and larger flowers,
improved plant quality, more uniform growth with increased
self-branching, and more attractive foliage than ‘Goldi-
locks’. Further, the following characteristics distinguish

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‘BullRudihir 116’ when generally compared to other *Rud-*
beckia varieties known to the breeder:

Large yellow flowers with a brown center;
Good self-branching;
An upright, compact, and uniform growth habit;
Healthy, green foliage;
Long bloom time;
Ease of growth;
Semi-double flowers; and
Unique flower color combination.

The new variety has been trial and field tested and has been
found to retain its distinctive characteristics and remain true
to type through successive asexual propagations. The pres-
ent invention has not been evaluated under all possible
environmental conditions. The phenotype may vary with
variations in environment without a change in the genotype
of the plant.

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The accompanying photographic drawing illustrates the
new variety at 18 weeks of age, with the color being as
nearly true as is possible with color illustrations of this type:
FIG. 1 shows an entire plant of the new variety.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLANT

The following detailed description sets forth the charac-
teristics of the new variety as the result of asexual repro-
ductions performed via in vitro tissue culture cuttings car-
ried out in Gönnebek, Germany. Plants of the new variety
were grown outdoors in 21 cm (4 liter) pots under normal
field production conditions. The color readings and mea-
surements were observed outdoors under natural light on 18
week old plants in Gönnebek, Germany. Color references
are primarily to The 2015 R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal

Horticultural Society of London, Sixth Edition, except where terms of ordinary significance are used.

PLANT

Time to initiate roots: About 7-10 days at approximately 18° C.

Time to develop roots: About 35-38 days at approximately 16-18° C.

Time to produce a finished flowering plant from a rooted cutting: About 11-14 weeks in a 21 cm container.

Rooting habit: Exhibits numerous roots of medium thickness that are freely branching and healthy in appearance.

Plant height: 50.0-65.0 cm.

Plant width: 35.0-45.0 cm.

Vigor: High, with an upright, compact, and uniform growth habit.

Disease/pest resistance: Nothing unusual noted to date.

Temperature tolerance: From -3 to +40° C.

Drought tolerance: Average.

Branching habit: Exhibits one dominant strong branch with several lateral side branches. The lateral branches are upright, forming an attractive habit.

Branches (flowering stems):

Number per plant.—10-22.

Length.—10.0-45.0 cm.

Diameter.—5.0-10.0 mm.

Internode length.—2.0-10.0 cm.

Angle.—Upright and outward.

Strength.—Strong.

Texture.—Pubescence present.

Color.—Close to Yellow-Green Group RHS 144A to 144B.

Foliage:

Arrangement.—Single.

Leaf.—Length: 6.0-22.0 cm. Width: 1.5-7.0 cm. Shape: Oblanceolate. Apex: Acuminate. Base: Attenuate to acute. Margin: Dentate and undulate. Texture: Upper surface: Rough, with pubescence present. Lower surface: Rough, with pubescence present. Color: Young leaves: Upper surface: Close to Green Group RHS 137B. Lower surface: Close to Green Group RHS 137C. Mature leaves: Upper surface: Close to Green Group RHS 137B to 137C. Lower surface: Close to Green Group RHS 137D. Petiole: None present. Veins: Venation type: Pinnate. Color: Upper surface: Close to Yellow-Green Group RHS 145C. Lower surface: Close to Yellow-Green Group RHS 145A.

INFLORESCENCE

Bud:

Diameter.—3.0-5.0 cm.

Length.—2.0-6.0 cm.

Color.—Close to Yellow-Green Group RHS 151A.

Appearance: Elliptic-shaped ray florets and tubular-shaped disc florets.

Natural flowering season: Flowering occurs from June-October in Gönnebek, Germany, beginning approximately 10-12 weeks after planting.

Average number of inflorescences per plant: 10-30.

Average number of inflorescences per branch: 1-5.

Disc and ray floret arrangement: Disc florets are arranged in the middle of the receptacle of the composite, semi-double, freely flowering plant, with ray florets extending outwardly therefrom.

5 Lastingness of an inflorescence on the plant: 5-6 weeks.

Lastingness of an inflorescence off the plant: 5-6 weeks.

Fragrance: Stable and very light.

Inflorescence:

Diameter.—10.0-16.0 cm.

Height (depth).—2.0-4.0 cm.

Diameter of disc.—2.5-6.0 cm.

Receptacle height.—1.0-1.5 cm.

Receptacle diameter.—4.0-8.0 cm.

15 Ray florets:

Number per inflorescence.—25-44.

Arrangement.—In two to three whorls.

Length.—4.0-8.0 cm.

Width.—1.5-2.8 cm.

20 *Shape.*—Elliptical.

Apex.—Emarginate.

Base.—Acute.

Margin.—Entire.

Texture.—Upper surface: Smooth and glabrous. Lower surface: Rough.

25 *Color.*—When opening: Upper surface: Close to Yellow-Orange Group RHS 17B. Lower surface: Close to Yellow-Orange Group RHS 15B. At maturity: Upper surface: Close to Yellow-Orange Group RHS 17B. Lower surface: Close to Yellow-Orange Group RHS 15B. Ground color description: Close to Yellow-Orange Group RHS 17B.

30 *Venation.*—Appearance: Parallel. Color: Upper surface: Same color as the florets. Lower surface: Same color as the florets.

35 Disc florets:

Number per inflorescence.—Numerous; too many to quantify.

Arrangement.—In the center of receptacle.

40 *Length.*—5.0-10.0 mm.

Width.—About 1.0 mm.

Shape.—Tubular.

Apex.—Five-pointed.

Color.—Immature: Close to Brown Group RHS 200A.

45 At maturity: Close to Brown Group RHS 200A.

Phyllaries:

Number per inflorescence.—30-40.

Arrangement.—In three whorls.

Length.—1.0-3.0 cm.

Width.—3.0-8.0 mm.

Shape.—Lanceolate.

Apex.—Elongated oval.

Base.—Fused.

Margin.—Undulate.

55 *Texture.*—Upper surface: Rough, with pubescence present. Lower surface: Rough, with pubescence present.

Color.—Immature: Upper surface: Close to Green Group RHS 138A. Lower surface: Close to Green Group RHS 138B. At maturity: Upper surface: Close to Green Group RHS 138A. Lower surface: Close to Green Group RHS 138B.

Reproductive organs:

Androecium:

65 *Presence.*—On disc and ray florets.

Number (per floret).—Numerous; too many to quantify.

Filament length.—1.0-2.0 mm.
Filament color.—Close to Brown Group RHS 200A.
Anther.—Shape: Oval. Length: 1.0 mm. Color: Close to Brown Group RHS 200A.
Pollen.—Color: Yellow-Orange Group RHS 16A. 5
Amount: Plentiful — too much to quantify.
Gynoecium:
Presence.—On disc florets.
Pistil length.—About 2.0 mm.
Stigma.—Shape: Two-parted. Color: Close to Brown 10
Group RHS 200A.

Style.—Length: 1.0-2.0 mm. Color: Close to Brown Group RHS 200A.
Seeds:
Overall size.—Approximately 2.0 mm in length and 1.0 mm in width.
Color.—Black Group RHS 202A.
I claim:
1. A new and distinct variety of *Rudbeckia* plant named ‘BullRudihir 116’, as is herein illustrated and described.
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